

CAPTAIN BLOODBRAIDS & MR. CRANSTON

Capt. Bloodbraids acts halfway through each round. Mr. Cranston acts at the end of each round. They can Interpose for one another within Reach 6.

Level 5 Large Pirate Captain  
Captain Bloodbraids M 40+10/HERO STR++

Mighty. She may choose either die to be her Primary Die.  
Whalebone Harpoon. 2d6+3/hero. On Crit: Impaled (Restrained, escape DC 13).  
Barbed Hooks. Heroes suffer 10 damage when Restrain ends. If anyone is already Impaled, withdraw the Harpoon before attacking again.

TIMELY DEPARTURE: At 0 HP, Captain Bloodbraids is Dying! She will attempt to escape on her flying whale boat.

Ornery Feathered Henchman  
Mr. Cranston 20+(10/HERO) DEX+  
Piercing Squawk. 3d6 damage (ignoring armor) to all enemies who can hear.



TRAVELING ENCOUNTERS

- 1

**Winged Shadow.** Grey albatross flies down to perch on the boat, Lets out an ornery **\*GRAWK\***

  - Pecks annoyingly at heroes and their belongings.
  - **DC 12 Naturecraft/Lore.** they reward respectful mariners. Being kind: It leaves behind a silvery feather and a Hero gains Inspiration. Scorn it: Cursed; healing halved until the next Safe Rest.
- 2

**Impending Hailstorm.** Push on or go around through skyfish banks.

  - **Brace the hail:** Get creative or the ship will be damaged—will have to repair it quickly or lighten the load!
  - **Go around:** Pack of Sky Eels attack (d6 minions, 4/hero). Half attack first—targeting the shiniest hero.
- 3

**Castaway Rock.** A disheveled fisherman (De Groot) waves from a floating islet.

  - He was the old cook on Captain Bloodbraid's ship (The Moray). Marooned, he claims, after refusing to poach.
  - Offers secrets in exchange for food and rescue: "Be ye aware of the monster locked in the Moray's stern!" and "Thar be a lookout, approach from below, lest ye' raise the alarm").
- 4

**Bluescale Rainbow.** With EVERY shade of blue (some you've never seen before!) crackles with energy.

  - **DC 14 Arcana/Lore:** Charged with wild magic. Those who cast a cantrip into it it: DC 12 INT save. Success: Gain a random Minor Boon (GM Guide Pg. 23): Roll 1d10, (on a 10 roll again twice). Failure: get the opposite of what's described. Both last until next Safe Rest.



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TAKE DOWN SKY PIRATES IN THEIR FLOATING SHIP-WRECK BASE IN THIS SKY-HIGH LEVEL 5 ADVENTURE.

WHAT'S GOING ON?

Colossal and majestic, **cloudwhales** were a marvel of the Skyreach Isles. Any sailor would recount how hearing their songs brought good fortune. But when it was discovered that their oil has gravity-defying properties like Aerolith Crystals, they were doomed. Hunted to near extinction by **sky pirates**, the Bird-folk established a secret Sanctuary for their conservation, but ruthless poachers are still on the hunt.

QUEST HOOKS

1. The **Birdfolk rangers** escorting the last cloudwhale calf to the Sanctuary never arrived. Find out what happened.
2. The poacher **Captain Bloodbraids** has been a bane in the Skyreach for too long. The Golden Company pays for her head.
3. An old fishmonger asks anyone leaving port to look for her estranged son, **Errol**, who left chasing some red-haired woman.

After overhearing the heroes' mission, an old sailor volunteers to take them on his flying dinghy (Aerolith Crystal installed). **Old Man Scroggins:** has a tall tale to one-up any anecdote. He fell overboard as a cabin boy and was saved by a cloudwhale.

TREASURES!



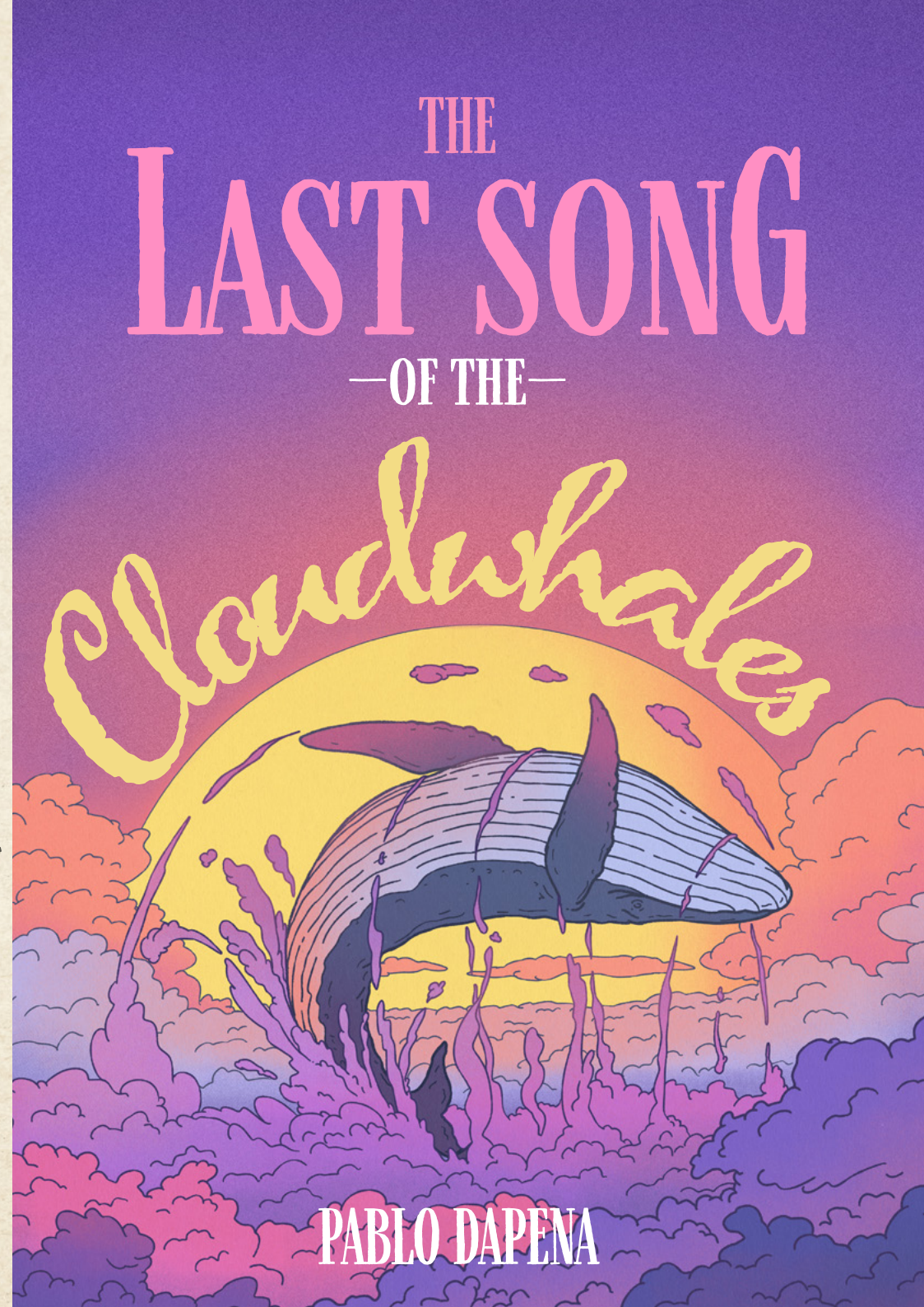
**Cask of Aeroil.** Spread on a creature or object: levitates for 1 hour. 5 uses, each enough for a medium-sized application. Flammable (and illegal).



**Conchie Talkies.** Pair of telepathic giant snails. Talk to one and the other relays the words if within a 5 range. They blow raspberries if out of reach. Must be fed regularly.



**Double Compass.** Two pointers, neither point North (one towards the nearest storm, the other is unknown.)



PABLO DAPENA

## THE MORAY

The **Moray** is Captain Bloodbraids' whaling base, and the wreck of her old ship. **Old Man Scroggins** advises that the heroes may board from the **Stern** or **Bow** Upper Decks, but coming from below seems best for a cautious approach (**Barnacle Caves**). Whatever their choice, Scroggins will tie the dinghy under the ship to stay out of sight.



**Raising the Alarm.** There is a lookout at the top of the Masts. If he spots or hears the heroes, he'll ring the bell and put the ship on Alert. Feel free to have the Poachers move about the ship looking for them if you'd like some dynamism.

Taking the lookout down or laying low for a while may allow the alert to pass as a false alarm.

### Bow Upper Deck. Pungent smell. Poachers, singing shanties.

- "What shall we do with a drunken whaaaler?..."; "Farewell and adieu to you Meeryvale ladies...".
- Whale carcass. **Bandit Bruisers** (1/hero) levitating tied to weights, extracting aeroil and cutting blubber. **Bandit Hunters** (1/hero) applying aeroil to a whaleboat. A second whaleboat hangs above them. **Alert:** Poachers vigilant and behind cover.
- Whaling tools: 2 handheld ballistas, harpoons, rope.
- Zipline up to the crow's nest (DC 12 Might to climb up).

### Cargo Hold. Crates, barrels and sacs. Musty.

- Food: fatty, salted meat (whale), hardtack, variety of bottles.
- Sailing equipment, grappling hooks, nets, 6 casks of aeroil.
- Searching: DC 10 Examination to notice rat droppings. Failure: rat bite (d4 damage, on crit: poisoned until healed). Loot: coral necklace, cane sugar sac (expensive).

### Shattered Lower Hull. Splintered and broken planks; many gaps. Hanging ropes. Sharp rocks below.

- 2 DC 15 checks to cross. Finesse to swing from ropes; Might to jump the gaps; or anything else creative.
- 1st failure: Gash, 1d8 damage; 2nd failure: fall through planks onto the rocks below, 1 Wound.

### Barnacle Caves. Narrow. Goopy droplets, acrid smell. Dead seagull (feathers... burnt? melted?).

- Barnacles covering walls and ceiling. DC 12 Naturecraft/Lore: Spitting Barnacles, spit acid on anything that moves (DC 16: Fire or lightning makes them retract).
- If careless, DC 14 DEX save or take 2d8 damage.

### The Masts. Rope ladders and rigging. Furled sails. Strong wind.

- Crow's nest on the main mast (Stern). Brass bell. Poacher with spyglass keeping watch (if alerted: rings the bell).
- Black flag: skull with red braids and crossed harpoons.
- Zipline from the crow's nest down to the Bow Upper Deck. (If not alerted, will surprise poachers there.)

### Stern Upper Deck. Mess of nets, rope and chains.

- Captured cloudwhale calf, moaning. If freed, it cowers in fear. Trust can be gained with gentle acts and seafood.
- On a crate: drawing of a cloudwhale ridden by human figures armed with whaling tools. Note: "Adult proved too difficult".
- The helm is above the Captain's Cabin, unmanned.

### Crew 's Quarters. Hammocks and snoring.

- Poachers resting (2 Bandits/hero + 1 Bandit Assassin/hero). **Alert:** Assassins attack first.
- Hammocks strung everywhere: Disadvantage for two-handed weapons and ranged attacks.
- Sea shanty songbook on a table.

### The Brig. Poorly lit cells. Foul smell.

- 3 Birdfolk Rangers captive. Poachers interrogating them about the location of the Cloudwhale Sanctuary, threatening to throw them down to "meet Errol". **Alert:** Poachers use prisoners as hostages.
- "They say he was a heartbreaker, but the only things I've seen him break are bones and flesh!" (1 Bandit Bruiser/hero) and the bosun, Half-nose Randall (Bandit Captain, 10hp/hero).
- The birdfolk are too weak to fight, but can help sail if the heroes need to make a hasty escape.
- Grated hatch down to Octopus Pond.

### Octopus Pond. Dark and damp. Sloshing sounds.

- **From Rope Bridges:** Heavy portcullis blocking the entrance (lever to open in Captain's Cabin). **From The Brig:** Grated hatch. (DC 20 Might to break, DC 18 Finesse to lock-pick, or other creative means may overcome these obstacles).
- Seawater pond. **Errol, Cursed Octopus** (with an eerily human face!) awaits, hungry. DC 15 Arcana/Insight: some sort of curse.
- This is Bloodbraids' former lover, Errol, who broke up with her after realizing she wasn't a natural redhead. His mind is almost gone, but can speak falteringly. Hates the crew, unless given a good reason, will assume heroes are also pirates.
- Pile of bones (Captain's coffer buried beneath: 500 gp, whispering jade skull).

### Captain 's Cabin. Stained old furniture. Messy.

- **Mr. Cranston:** eagle-sized parrot, sailor's mouth. Will attempt to call the Captain with a Conchie Talkie. **Alert:** Mr. Cranston has already called the Captain (Disadvantage on Initiative).
- Lever next to octopus sign: raises the Octopus Pond portcullis.
- Ornate scrimshaw etching of a landscape (treasure map?).
- **Locked Chest:** Pirate clothes, 3 gold pieces, useless fake loot, an obvious false bottom: Logbook and a bottle with a scroll inside. Logbook: ramblings about a "slimy traitor", followed by hiring a sea-witch to "deal with him"; plans to tame a cloudwhale to approach pods undetected. Inside the bottle, a seaweed scroll that reads:

EIGHT MONTHS OF LIES, EIGHT LIMBS, YOUR PRIZE  
EIGHT DEEDS OF GRACE, REVERTS THE GUISE

(8 people doing a kind deed for Errol will break the curse!)

## CAPT. BLOODBRAIDS' ARRIVAL

Burly half-giant; red braids; a serrated whalebone harpoon where her right hand should be. She's out hunting, but arrives when the heroes are looking to leave (sooner, if alerted by Mr. Cranston) piloting a flying whaleboat. **Loot:** One Conchie Talkie, Double Compass.

## AFTERMATH

- **Cloudwhales.** After the confrontation, a pod appears to guide the calf back. As they fly away, the heroes hear their song.
- **Captain Bloodbraids.** If her plans were thwarted but she escapes, swearing vengeance.
- **Birdfolk Patrol.** If helped, they declare the heroes as allies to their cause and give them a token of camaraderie.
- **Errol.** If he survives and the curse is broken, he reunites with his aging mother. He disappears 2 months later, chasing another redhead.
- **De Groot.** If rescued, he opens a tavern in Farhope: *The Briny Cockle*. Free drinks and lodging for the heroes.

### ERROL, CURSED OCTOPUS 120

After each hero's turn, choose 1:

- **Tentacle.** (Reach 8) 1d8, on hit: Grappled (escape DC 12).
- **Beak Bite.** (VS a grappled target) 2d8+8.

**Bloodied:** At 60 HP Releases all Grappled foes, \*you *think* the monster gurgled something?" (DC 12 Insight check) "*pLeAsE, nO...*" On failure: Just your imagination?



## BANDITS

**Parry.** Treat attacks against you that roll 2 as a miss.

**BANDIT HUNTER** LVL 1 22  
**Battlebow.** 2d8+2 (Range 12).

**BANDIT BRUISER** LVL 2 M 24  
**Bash.** 2d8+4.

**BANDIT ASSASSIN** LVL 2 24  
**Sneak.** Invisible until you attack.

**Poison Blade(2x).** 1d8+2.  
On damage: Dazed.